

ARTERY OF DEVELOPMENT An interchange on the Ganga Expressway

A NEW ROAD TO RICHES

UTTAR PRADESH'S LONGEST HIGH-SPEED EXPRESSWAY AIMS TO BRIDGE THE STATE'S WESTERN AND EASTERN REGIONS, LINKING 12 DISTRICTS AND CREATING AN ECONOMIC CORRIDOR ALONG ITS STRETCH

By AVANEESH MISHRA

ON

APRIL 29, PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI INAUGURATED what promises to be a new economic spine for Uttar Pradesh: the 594-kilometre-long Ganga Expressway. Stretching from Bijauli village in Meerut to Judapur Dandu in Prayagraj, the high-speed corridor cuts across 12 districts—Meerut, Hapur, Bulandshahr, Amroha, Sambhal, Budaun, Shahjahanpur, Hardoi, Unnao, Raebareli, Pratapgarh and Prayagraj—bringing more than 500 villages onto the network and linking western UP with its central and eastern regions.

The six-lane expressway, expandable to eight lanes, has a 120-metre-wide right-of-way and is designed for speeds of up to 120 kmph. It will